

Superintendent Pay in Context

Andover, CT · Dr. Valerie Bruneau and her Connecticut peers · FY 2025–26

A personal report by Scott Sauyet · scott@sauyet.com · Not an official town document

Data was assembled by crawling 45 small Connecticut town and school district websites, OCR'ing scanned PDF contracts, manually reviewing contracts shared as Google Drive links, incorporating findings from an online research-agent collaboration, and obtaining contracts directly from town clerks under CGS § 10-244c records requests. Of the 45 peer districts identified as comparable to Andover, 38 peer districts (30 unique superintendent contracts) have contract data in hand; two HS-only reference contracts — for Amity Regional School District No. 5 (Byars, the regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Bethany, Orange, Woodbridge) and Northwestern Region 7 (LePage, the regional 7-12 supe shared by Barkhamsted, Colebrook, New Hartford, Norfolk) — are also included in the broadest view for context. For the remaining 6 peer districts a thorough search of public sites and clerk outreach have not yet produced the current contract. All figures are "cash compensation" — the salary line plus any board-paid 403(b) annuity, longevity bonus, fixed transportation allowance, and other lump sums. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are excluded. Because Connecticut superintendent contracts vary widely in work effort — from 12-hour-per-week part-time positions to full-time K-12 regional superintendents — all dollar figures are normalized to a hypothetical 1.0-FTE-equivalent (260-day work year) for apples-to-apples comparison. Andover's portion of Dr. Bruneau's compensation is reported separately so readers can see both what Andover pays and what her market-rate compensation works out to.

INTRODUCTION

Overview

Dr. Valerie Bruneau is Andover's Superintendent of Schools. She is also Scotland's, under a separate Scotland contract that has now been located (its most recent vintage on file is 2021-2024). Her time is split 60/40 between the two K-6 districts — 0.6 FTE at Andover and 0.4 FTE at Scotland — a structure that the Andover and Scotland contracts each state explicitly. Andover's contract pays her \$90,000 cash plus a \$10,000 mandatory 403(b) deferral for the 2025–26 school year, for an Andover-paid total of \$100,000. Treating that as the Andover-share of a single full-time job, her implied 1.0-FTE-equivalent compensation is **\$166,667**.

This report sets that figure in context by comparing it to every other Connecticut superintendent contract we could find for the 45 small towns identified as peers — towns of similar size, similar grade-level structure, and similar regional profile. The contracts vary in age and scope, so the report presents two different cuts of the data, each with different inclusion rules. Andover sits at the bottom of both.

One overall pattern is worth flagging up front: **within the K-6/K-8 cohort, FTE-equivalent pay is essentially uncorrelated with district enrollment** (Pearson $r \approx 0.13$ across 24 K-6/K-8 solo contracts). Small Connecticut elementary districts pay their superintendents in a fairly narrow band roughly independent of whether the district has 100 students or 1,200. The going rate is a market price for the role, not a per-student rate. This makes the scatter plot in the “Pay vs district size” section below relatively flat within the K-6/K-8 band — a fact that carries some weight when thinking about what Andover’s compensation should be.

METHODOLOGY

A note on methodology before the numbers

Two methodological choices shape every table that follows. Both deserve a line of explanation before the numbers appear.

FTE-equivalent, not raw salary. Andover is a small K-6 district that shares its superintendent with Scotland. Other towns in the peer set are also small enough to share — Region 4 (Chester, Deep River, Essex/Centerbrook) has one K-12 superintendent across four boards; ER9 (Easton, Redding, Region 9) has one across three. Comparing Andover’s \$100,000 Andover-paid amount to Region 4’s per-town share isn’t apples-to-apples because Andover is paying for 60% of a person’s time while Region 4 districts are each paying for 25% of a different person’s time. The FTE-equivalent normalization expresses each contract as “what would this superintendent earn if working a full 260-day work year at this district’s pay rate.” It is the metric that makes contracts comparable across different sharing arrangements.

By contract, not by district. When three boards sign one joint contract (McKinnon for ER9; White for Region 4), it is one observation, not three. The tables in this report dedupe by contract for joint cases (one row for McKinnon, listing Easton/Redding; one for White, listing Centerbrook/Chester/Deep River). Where two districts share a superintendent under *separate* contracts, each is counted as its own observation. Bruneau’s Andover and Scotland contracts are the canonical example: she appears under Andover (2025-26 contract) and again under Scotland (2021-22, the latest Scotland contract located).

Part 1 — Dr. Bruneau’s contract

The current Andover contract runs from July 1, 2023 through June 30, 2026. Section 2 explicitly defines the role as a 0.60 FTE position. Section 4 defines “annual base salary” as the sum of (a) a cash component paid biweekly and (b) a \$10,000 mandatory deferral into a 403(b) annuity. The three contract-year figures are:

Andover’s portion of Dr. Bruneau’s compensation

Contract year	Cash component	403(b) deferral	Andover-paid total
2023–24	\$80,000	\$10,000	\$90,000
2024–25	\$85,000	\$10,000	\$95,000
2025–26	\$90,000	\$10,000	\$100,000

Notes: Source: [Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026](https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf), Section 4 (BASE SALARY). The 403(b) amount is technically a “salary reduction agreement” — the Superintendent elects to defer \$10,000 of her base salary into a tax-sheltered annuity — but it is part of the total compensation the Board is obligated to provide, and the Board reports the full \$90K+\$10K total to the Connecticut State Teachers’ Retirement System.

What “\$166,667” includes. The comparison tables in Part 3 sum, for every contract, the same cash items: the salary cash component plus the board-paid or board-provided 403(b) annuity plus any longevity bonus plus any fixed transportation allowance. For Bruneau in 2025–26 that is \$90,000 cash + \$10,000 annuity = \$100,000 — both lines included, not just the salary cash. Divided by Andover’s 0.6 FTE share gives the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate of \$166,667 used in every comparison below. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are *not* included for any contract — see the Methodology italic at the top of the report. The treatment is uniform: if a peer contract has its own annuity, it is added in the same way.

The 2026–2029 successor contract — referenced in the FY26/FY27 town budget approved February 11, 2026 — proposes a \$100,000 cash component for FY 2026–27, plus a \$15,000 annuity (up from \$10,000). Part 4 returns to that figure and shows where it would land in the current peer distribution.

Part 2 — The peer cohort

The original peer list contained 45 small Connecticut towns selected for similarity to Andover (small enrollment, small budget, K-6 or K-8 elementary structure, sometimes regional secondary). After excluding Norwich (which is structurally very different — much larger, much more urban), the working comparison set is 44 districts.

Of those 44, contract data is in hand for **31 unique superintendent contracts covering 39 peer districts. 30 of those contracts are ranked in the tables below**; three are treated as reference observations because the K-6/K-8 comparison isn't clean for them, and they appear on the [contracts subpage](#) but aren't ranked:

- **Amity Region 5** (Byars) — HS-only regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Bethany, Orange, and Woodbridge.
- **Northwestern Region 7** (LePage) — HS-only regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Barkhamsted, Colebrook, New Hartford, and Norfolk.
- **Chaplin / Region 11** (Skarzynski) — joint K-12 contract for Chaplin K-6 and Region 11 HS. Skarzynski also holds a separate 0.3-FTE Hampton contract, which makes the FTE denominator for the joint contract unreliable (treating it as 1.0 FTE would put his total at 1.3 FTE across all roles, which isn't physically plausible). Treating it as reference-only avoids a misleadingly low FTE-equivalent number in the ranking.

Only **5 peer districts remain pending**: Woodbridge (K-6 supe being recruited), plus four very small EASTCONN-region districts where part-time superintendent arrangements are common but the supe's name and tenure are not always established with certainty (Ashford, North Franklin, Pomfret Center, Union).

CGS § 10-244c (Public Act 17-2) directs town clerks to post superintendent contracts on the town website, but compliance is uneven. Requesting a copy from the town clerk — including via the state's Freedom of Information process — has turned out to be highly effective; almost every contract in the dataset that wasn't publicly posted was obtained through a polite records request to the town clerk.

The full list of pending districts appears in Sources at the end.

Part 3 — Two views of the comparison

The underlying data supports two views, each with a different inclusion rule. Both use the same vintage-fallback policy — **2025-26 data where we have it, 2024-25 if we don't, 2026-27 if that's all we have**. Older "stale" data is excluded from these tables but the underlying PDFs remain available in the [contracts](#) subpage and in the [spreadsheet](#) for inspection.

View 1 — All contracts we can find (current vintage)

The most inclusive ranked view. Includes every ranked contract whose data passes the vintage-fallback rule, regardless of grade-level scope. One contract — Byars Amity Region 5 — appears as an HS-only reference; two — Lisbon (Keating) and Sterling (Friend) — have their own contract-shape oddities flagged in the table notes.

Andover ranks **29th of 29** — last. Mean: \$212,100. Median: \$200,000.

Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Dr. Jason McKinnon	2025–26	Easton, Redding	\$310,408
2	Brian J. White	2025–26	Centerbrook, Chester, Deep River	\$277,649
3	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
4	Sally A. Keating §	2026–27	Lisbon	\$251,210
5	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
6	Melony M. Brady-Shanley	2025–26	Falls Village, Kent, Lakeville, North Canaan, Sharon, West Cornwall	\$245,610
7	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
8	Dr. Jennifer Byars †	2025–26	Amity Region 5 (Bethany/Orange/Woodbridge)	\$243,762
9	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
10	Dr. Holly B. Hageman	2025–26	Marlborough	\$222,222
11	Theodore F. Friend §	2026–27	Sterling	\$219,860
12	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
13	Barbara Wilson	2025–26	Columbia	\$202,400
14	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
15	Dr. Candace Morell	2025–26	Storrs (Mansfield)	\$200,000
16	Brian Hendrickson	2025–26	Salem	\$197,699
17	Robert Gilbert	2025–26	Colebrook	\$195,620
18	Jeffrey F. Sousa	2025–26	New Hartford	\$193,250
19	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
20	Christopher Roche	2025–26	Woodstock	\$190,000
21	Dr. Julie Luby	2025–26	Winsted	\$189,100
22	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
23	Kai Byrd	2024–25	Bethany	\$184,642
24	Dr. Christopher Bitgood	2025–26	Canterbury	\$183,801
25	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307

Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
26	Andrew Skarzynski (Hampton)	2025–26	Hampton	\$179,167
27	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
28	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
29	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667

Notes: † Byars’s Amity Region 5 contract covers high-school-only (grades 7–12), a meaningfully different scope from the elementary-only superintendents that dominate this list — included as a reference observation representing 7-12 supervision paid by member towns through a regional district. § Lisbon and Sterling are entered under the vintage-fallback rule with 2026-27 contract data because no 2024-25 or 2025-26 data has been located for those districts. Their figures are the earliest year of a future-effective contract and may be re-papered upward by the time those years arrive. Skarzynski also serves Hampton K-8 under a separate part-time contract (rank 26 above); his separate Chaplin+Region 11 joint K-12 contract is treated as a reference (see Part 2 introduction) rather than ranked, because the joint contract’s FTE denominator is entangled with the Hampton contract in a way we can’t cleanly resolve. The Steven LePage Region 7 (2023-2026) contract is excluded under the vintage-fallback rule because we have year-1 data only and the rule requires 2024-25 or newer — the PDF remains on the contracts subpage for reference.

View 2 — K-6 / K-8 only, current contracts only (strict)

The most apples-to-apples view: K-6/K-8 scope, contract data from 2024–25 or 2025-26 (no future-fallback). This eliminates uncertainty about whether older contracts have been renegotiated since and removes the joint-K-12 and HS-only outliers.

Andover ranks **23rd of 23** — last. Mean: \$200,104. Median: \$193,250. Andover is **–14% below the median**.

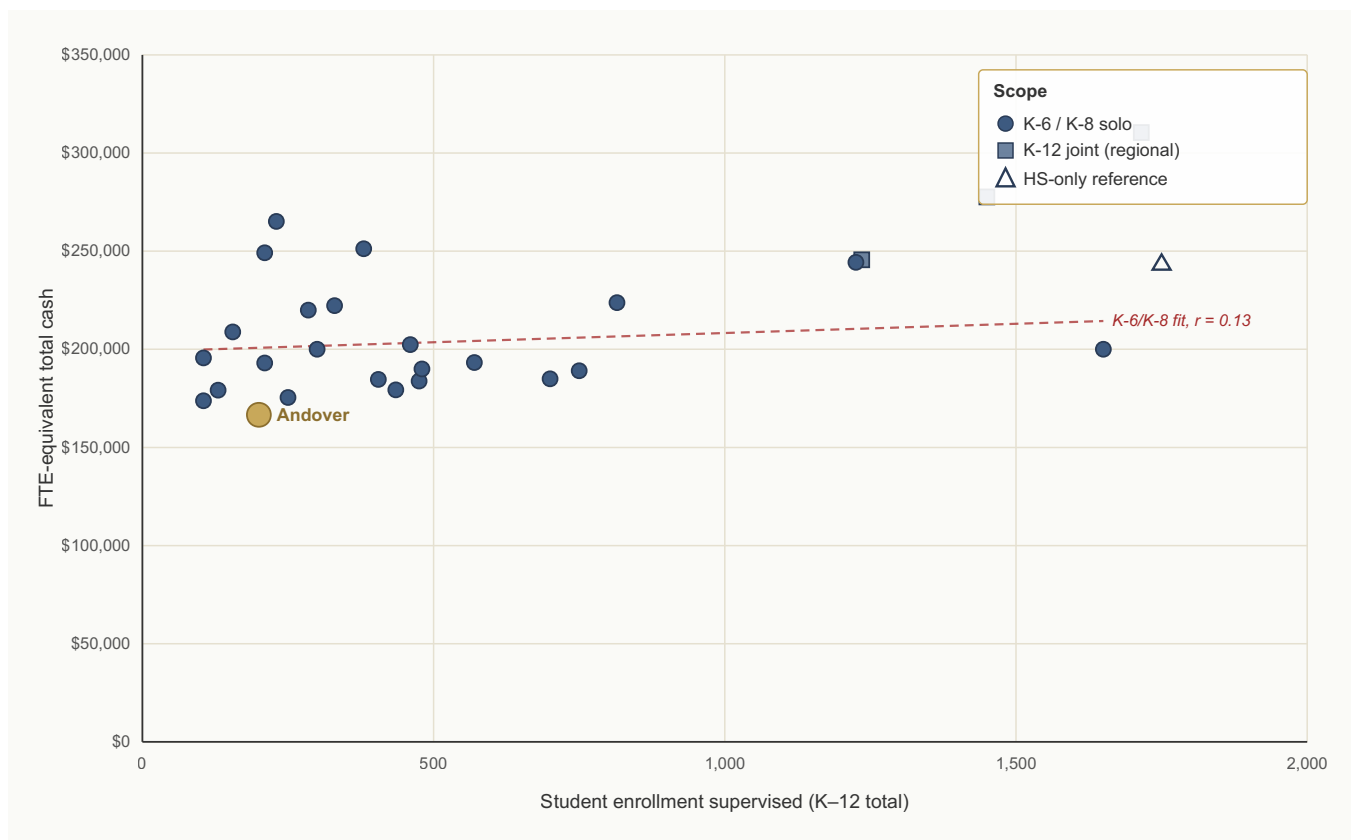
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Notes: Filter: --scope k-6,k-8 (the strict rule). **No K-6/K-8 peer with a current contract pays less than Andover.** The next-lowest peer — Norfolk at \$173,750 — pays 4% more than Andover does. Scotland is not in this table because Bruneau’s Scotland contract that we have is stale (2021–22); a current Scotland contract would be expected to enter at the same \$166,667 FTE-equivalent as Andover, since the two are proportional sides of the same 1.0 FTE. The median is \$193,250 (15.9% above Andover); the mean is \$200,104 (20.1% above Andover).

ENROLLMENT

Pay vs district size

The two views above rank districts by FTE-equivalent pay only. This scatter overlays that pay figure against the total student enrollment the superintendent supervises, which is one of the plainer proxies for the job’s scale.



Notes: Enrollment counts are the K–12 student totals under the superintendent’s supervision for the 2024–25 school year (CT EdSight October-1 counts). For solo K-6/K-8 contracts, that’s the district’s elementary enrollment. For joint K-12 regional contracts (McKinnon ER9, White Region 4, Brady-Shanley Region 1), the count is the sum across all member districts’ K-8 populations plus the regional HS. For the two HS-only reference contracts (LePage Region 7, Byars Amity Region 5), only the regional HS enrollment is shown. Andover’s point is highlighted; the four contracts nearest Andover in enrollment all pay substantially more per FTE. Enrollment values are cross-checked against published district budgets where available; where only approximate counts were available they are flagged in `enrollment.json` in the working repository.

AT A GLANCE

Summary table

Question	Answer
What does Andover pay Dr. Bruneau for FY 2025–26?	\$90,000 cash + \$10,000 403(b) = \$100,000 total
What’s the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate that implies?	\$166,667 (Andover’s share is 60% of a full-time position)
Where does that rank against peer Connecticut superintendents?	Last of 29 in the broad view; last of 23 in the strict K-6/K-8 view
How far below the K-6/K-8 peer median is Andover?	\$26,583 (–14%) below the strict K-6/K-8 median of \$193,250; \$33,333 (–17%) below the broad-view median of \$200,000
Does any K-6/K-8 peer with a 2024-or-newer contract pay less?	No. Andover is at the bottom of every current-data peer cohort.
What is “cash compensation” in this report?	Base salary + board-contributed 403(b) + longevity bonuses + fixed transportation allowances
What’s excluded?	Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, LTD, IRS-rate mileage, sick-day buyback

Key Observations

Andover's superintendent rate is unambiguously below peer rates across every cut of the data. The bottom-of-the-distribution finding is not an artifact of one inclusion rule. Whether you use the broad view (every ranked contract with current data, all scopes — N=29) or the strict view (K-6/K-8 only, current data — N=23), Andover is last with no peer below.

The strict K-6/K-8 view is the cleanest comparison. It eliminates two confounders — scope mismatch (K-12 regional supes earn more because their role is bigger) and stale data (older contracts almost certainly have step-ups not visible from the dollar figures we have). In that view, Andover is rank 23 of 23 — last — and no K-6/K-8 peer with a current contract pays less. The next-lowest current K-6/K-8 peer is Norfolk at \$173,750, 4% above Andover; the median is \$193,250, roughly 16% above.

Stale and reference-only contracts don't appear in the ranking tables. The underlying older PDFs (Stevens West Willington 2023–24, Leake Eastford 2021–22, Bruneau Scotland 2021–22, LePage Region 7 2023–24) and the three reference contracts (Amity Region 5, Region 7, Skarzynski Chaplin+Region 11) remain on the [contracts subpage](#) and in the [downloadable spreadsheet](#) for inspection.

Enrollment doesn't explain the gap. Within the K-6/K-8 cohort, pay and enrollment are essentially uncorrelated (Pearson $r \approx 0.13$, $r^2 \approx 0.02$ — roughly 2% of the pay variance is “explained” by district size). Small CT elementary districts pay their superintendents in a fairly narrow band of \$175K–\$220K per FTE regardless of whether they have 100 students or 1,200, which the scatter plot in “Pay vs district size” above makes visible. Andover sits well below that band. The apparent upward trend in the full-cohort scatter comes from the K-12 regional joint contracts (McKinnon ER9, White Region 4, Brady-Shanley Region 1) at the top-right, not from the K-6/K-8 cohort where Andover competes.

Only 5 peer districts remain pending. Records requests to town clerks under CGS §10-244c have resolved essentially every contract that could be resolved that way. The remaining five — Ashford, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Union, Woodbridge — are the smallest of the EASTCONN-area districts plus Woodbridge, which is between supes. The missing rates could land above or below Andover's; whether they do is genuinely unknown.

CAVEATS

What this report does not show

- **Total compensation** including health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage. These items vary widely across districts and a fair comparison would require valuing each district's specific health plan; the cash-only comparison sidesteps that.

- **Years of experience or tenure.** A first-year superintendent at \$200,000 is a different observation from a 20-year veteran at \$200,000. This report treats every contract uniformly regardless of the superintendent's experience.
- **Cost of living adjustments.** Fairfield County districts (Easton, Redding) have higher local costs than the eastern Connecticut towns that dominate the lower end of this distribution. The FTE-equivalent figures are nominal, not cost-of-living-adjusted.
- **Per-pupil or per-budget normalization.** A larger district legitimately needs a more senior superintendent, and some peers manage two or three times Andover's enrollment. This report normalizes by FTE, not by enrollment or budget size.
- **The missing peers.** The 5 districts where clerk outreach has not yet produced a current contract may have rates above or below the current cohort.
- **A causal claim about appropriateness.** This report describes where Andover sits in the peer distribution. It does not argue that being below median is good or bad, or that any particular pay rate is the "right" one. That is a judgment for residents.

DOCUMENTATION

Sources

Bulk downloads

- **All contracts as a zipped archive** — every PDF referenced below, organized by district slug, with a manifest CSV.
- **Contracts subpage** — sortable table linking directly to each contract PDF; stale and future-dated entries included with flags for inspection.

(The component-level spreadsheet that complements these sources is in the [Other Formats](#) section below.)

Andover-specific documents

- **Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026** — [andoverelementaryct.org/.../2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf](https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/.../2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (scanned PDF, OCR'd)
- **Andover FY26/FY27 Town Budget** — approved at the February 11, 2026 Town Meeting; provides FY27 proposed figures

Pending — contract not located in public search (5)

Five peer districts remain pending. Woodbridge is in transition (K-6 supe being recruited); the other four are very small EASTCONN-region districts where part-time supe arrangements are common and the supe's name and tenure aren't always established with certainty: Ashford, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Union.

All 30 peer-district contracts in the analysis plus the two HS-only reference contracts are listed with links on the [Contracts subpage](#) and included in the [downloadable ZIP](#) and [spreadsheet](#).

Excluded

Norwich (too dissimilar in size and structure to be a useful peer).

Statutory basis

- CT Public Act 17-2 § 157 / CGS § 10-244c (requirement to post superintendent contracts on town websites)

Methodology and tooling

The full data pipeline, including the web scraper, OCR pipeline, comparison script, and `compensation.json` data file, lives in a separate working repository. The corrections log inside that data file documents the instances where automated attribution was wrong and was corrected by manual review — including, most notably, that an early Region 1 contract attribution turned out to be a New Canaan contract incorrectly hosted under a `"/canaan"` CMS subdomain, and that Salem's contract had been read at 1.0 FTE before the contract text was verified to specify 28 hours per week (a 0.7 FTE adjustment).

Findings from an online research-agent collaboration (Connecticut town clerk contact research, regional district structure mapping, supe-tenure timelines) resolved several structural questions, most importantly that Region 1 operates under a single Joint Employment Agreement for one shared K-12 superintendent across all seven member boards — a finding that has now been confirmed by retrieving the actual Brady-Shanley contract (one contract resolved six pending peer districts).

A custom **town-clerk outreach app** (the "clerks tracker" at andoverct.info/clerks) manages §10-244c records requests at scale: it renders templated outreach emails per district, tracks reply status, holds received PDFs in a per-district uploads folder, and exports the entire dataset as a single zip. Most contracts in this analysis were obtained through that pipeline.

Other Formats

This report is available in four formats, all located alongside this page:



HTML

Interactive version with formatted tables; best for on-screen reading and sharing.



Markdown

Plain-text version; readable in any editor, ideal for copying into other documents.



PDF

Print-ready version with all tables, footnotes, and source citations.



Spreadsheet (XLSX)

Every contract's cash components (base, annuity, longevity, transport, dues, other) on a By-district sheet and a deduped By-contract sheet. Hyperlinks to each PDF.